Paul Novosad

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Professional Positions

Professor | Dartmouth College	**2026–**
Associate Professor | Dartmouth College	**2020–2026**
Assistant Professor | Dartmouth College	**2013–2020**
Founder | Development Data Lab	**2019–**

Education

PhD in Political Economy and Government, Harvard University	**2013**
MPA International Development, Harvard University	**2004**
BA English, University of Calgary	**1999**

Publications / In Press

1. Sam Asher Ⓡ Kritarth Jha Ⓡ **Paul Novosad** Ⓡ Anjali Adukia Ⓡ Brandon Tan, "Residential Segregation and Unequal Access to Local Public Services in India: Evidence from 1.2m Neighborhoods," Conditionally accepted at *American Economic Review*.

2. Sam Asher, Eni Iljazi, Catriona Farquharson, and **Paul Novosad**, "Access to Opportunity in the Sciences: Evidence from the Nobel Laureates," Conditionally accepted at *Review of Economics and Statistics*.

3. Elliott Ash, Sam Asher, Aditi Bhowmick, Sandeep Bhupatiraju, Daniel Chen, Tanaya Devi, Christoph Goessman, **Paul Novosad**, and Bilal Siddiqi, "In-group bias in the Indian judiciary: Evidence from 5 million criminal cases," Forthcoming at *Review of Economics and Statistics*.

4. Sam Asher, **Paul Novosad**, and Charlie Rafkin, "Intergenerational Mobility in India: New Measures and Estimates Across Time, Space, and Communities," *AEJ: Applied* 16:2 (2024).

5. Sam Asher, **Paul Novosad**, "Rent-Seeking and Criminal Politicians: Evidence from Mining Booms," *Review of Economics and Statistics* 105: 1 (2023).

6. Prabhat Jha, Yashwant Deshmukh, Chinmay Tumbe, Wilson Suraweera, Aditi Bhowmick, Sankalp Sharma, **Paul Novosad**, Sze Hang Fu, Leslie Newcombe, Hellen Gelband, and Patrick Brown, "COVID mortality in India: National survey data and health facility deaths," *Science* 10.1126/science.abm5154 (2022).

7. **Paul Novosad**, Charlie Rafkin, and Sam Asher, "Mortality Change Among Less Educated Americans," *AEJ: Applied* 14:4 (2022).

8. Aarushi Kalra and **Paul Novosad**, "Impacts of regional lockdown policies on COVID-19 transmission in India in 2020," *Economics and Politics Weekly* 57:14 (2022).

9. Sam Asher, Aditi Bhowmick, Alison Campion, Tobias Lunt, **Paul Novosad**, "Big, Open Data for Development: A Vision for India," *India Policy Forum* (2021, not peer reviewed).

10. Sam Asher, Toby Lunt, Ryu Matsuura, **Paul Novosad**, "Development Research at High Geographic Resolution: An Analysis of Night Lights, Firms, and Poverty in India using the SHRUG Open Data Platform," *World Bank Economic Review* 35:4 (2021).

11. Rebecca Cai, **Paul Novosad**, Vaidehi Tandel, Sam Asher, and Anup Malani, "Representative Estimates of COVID-19 Infection Fatality Rates from Four Locations in India," *BMJ Open* 9:1 (2021).

12. Sam Asher, **Paul Novosad**, "Rural Roads and Local Economic Development," *American Economic Review* 110:3 (2020).

13. Anjali Adukia, Sam Asher, and **Paul Novosad**, "Educational Investment Responses to Economic Opportunity: Evidence from Indian Road Construction," *AEJ: Applied* 12:1 (2020).

14. Sam Asher, Teevrat Garg, and **Paul Novosad**, "The Ecological Footprint of Transportation Infrastructure," *Economic Journal* 130:629 (2020).

15. **Paul Novosad**, Radhika Jain, Alison Campion, and Sam Asher, "COVID-19 mortality effects of underlying health conditions in India: a modelling study," *BMJ Open* 10:e043165 (2020).

16. **Paul Novosad** and Eric Werker, "Who Runs the International System? Nationality and Leadership in the United Nations Secretariat," *The Review of International Organizations* 14:1 (2019).

17. Sam Asher and **Paul Novosad**, "Politics and Local Economic Growth: Evidence from India," *AEJ: Applied* 9:1 (2017).

Work in Progress

1. Sam Asher, Aditi Bhowmick, Maurizio Bussolo, and **Paul Novosad**, "Cultural capital and access to opportunity: Evidence from subcaste norms in India," Working paper.

2. Sam Asher, Alison Campion, Doug Gollin, and **Paul Novosad**, "The Long-run Development Impacts of Agricultural Productivity Gains: Evidence from Irrigation Canals in India," Revision requested at *Review of Economic Studies*.

3. Aditi Bhowmick Ⓡ Sara Sethia Ⓡ Jonah Rexer Ⓡ **Paul Novosad** Ⓡ Maurizio Bussolo Ⓡ Sam Asher, "The Female Urban Mobility Advantage in South Asia," Working paper.

On Hold or Retired

1. Sam Asher and **Paul Novosad**, "Digging for Development: Economic Impacts of Mining Booms," Working paper.

2. Anup Malani, **Paul Novosad**, et al., "Adaptive Control of COVID-19 Outbreaks in India: Local, Gradual, and Trigger-based Exit Paths from Lockdown," Working paper.

3. Sam Asher and **Paul Novosad**, "The Impacts of Local Control over Political Institutions: Evidence from State Splitting in India," Working paper.

4. Sam Asher, Karan Nagpal and **Paul Novosad**, "The Cost of Distance: Geography and Governance in Rural India," Working paper.

5. Denis Nekipelov, **Paul Novosad**, and Stephen P. Ryan, "Moment Forests," NBER Working Paper No. 22976.

6. Sam Asher, **Paul Novosad** and Charlie Rafkin, "Getting Signal from Interval Data: Theory and Applications to Mortality and Intergenerational Mobility," Working paper.

Papers from Past Lives

1. Leyenaar, J., **Novosad P.**, Ferrer K., Thahane, L., Mohapi E., Schutze G., Kline M.. "Early Clinical Outcomes in Children Enrolled in HIV Infection, Care and Treatment in Lesotho," *The Pediatric Infectious Diseases Journal*, Vol. 29:4.

2. Hoang Lan Anh, Castella J.C., **Novosad P.**. "Social networks and information access: Implications for agricultural extension in a rice farming community in northern Vietnam." *Agriculture and Human Values: Journal of the Agriculture, Food and Human Values Society*, Vol. 23:4.

3. Castella J.C., Boissau S., Nguyen Hai Thanh, **Novosad P.**. "Impact of forestland allocation on land use in a mountainous province of Vietnam," *Land Use Policy* 23.

4. Castella J.C., Gevraise V., **Novosad P.**. "Centralized planning and economic reforms in a mountain region of Vietnam," *Journal of Contemporary Asia*, Vol. 35:2.

Awards and Research Funding

2026 World Bank: Urban Labor Markets in Low- and Middle-Income Countries

2025 International Growth Centre: Fostering sustainable urbanization

2025 Structural Transformation and Growth (STEG): Urban Data Center

2025 European Research Council grant (to Co-PI Sam Asher): Culture and Economic Change in India

2024 World Bank: Cultural Distance and Economic Opportunity

2023 World Bank: Intergenerational Mobility Across South Asia

2022 India-Swiss Joint Research Program Grant: Big Data for Justice in India

2021 Weiss Fund: The Long Run Impacts of Investments in Agricultural Productivity

2021 Dartmouth Innovation and Advancement Award: Gender Inequality and Social Norms

2021 World Bank: Intergenerational Mobility in South Asia

2021 STEG Large Research Grant: Structural Transformation and Gender Norms in the Long Run

2020 PEDL Exploratory Research Grant: Economic Impact of Mining Booms

2020 Omidyar Foundation: Data Platform Support for the Government of India

2019 World Bank Agriculture Global Practice: Long-Run Impacts of Canals

2019 Emergent Ventures: A Scalable Socioeconomic Data Platform for India

2016 IGC Central: Rapid Urbanization, Rural-to-Urban Migration and Rural Development

2015 IGC Tanzania: The Cost of Rural Road Construction in Tanzania

2015 IGC Central: Impacts of Rural Roads in India

2014 IZA/DFID Growth and Labour Markets in Low Income Countries: Urban Geography of Enterpreneurship and Growth

2013 Private Enterprise in Low-Income Countries, Centre for European Policy Research: Urban Geography of Entrepreneurship

2011 Merit Fellowship, Graduate School of Arts and Sciences, Harvard

2009 Warburg Fund Award, Department of Economics, Harvard

Invited Presentations

2014: Cornell University (Development and Public Economics Seminar Series), NEUDC, World Bank (South Asia Decentralization Series), Indian Planning Commission.

2015: World Bank (Microeconomics Group), CSAE, NEUDC, Yale (Leitner Seminar), IFPRI (Applied Microeconomics Seminar).

2016: IGC Cities (London), Barcelona Summer Forum, Harvard (Cities and Development Conference), World Bank (Conference on Inequality), NEUDC, Boston University.

2017: Harris School of Public Policy, Yale (Conference on Agriculture, Structural Transformation and Development), Harvard (Cities and Development Conference), Journées Louis-Andre Gerard-Varet (Aix-Marseilles), Barcelona Summer Forum, World Bank, Berkeley (Political Economy Seminar), UCSD, World Bank (IZA Labor Markets Conference, NEUDC, BREAD / NBER Development, Center for Policy Research (Delhi), Indian Ministry of Rural Development.

2018: Fordham University (Economics Seminar), Stanford (Conference on Indian Economic Policy), Paris School of Economics (India-China Conference), Barcelona Summer Forum, Yale (India Migration Conference), NBER Economics of Education, University of Michigan (Ford School of Public Policy Economics Seminar).

2019: Georgetown University (Economics Seminar), Johns Hopkins SAIS (Cities Development Workshop), Statistics Norway, World Bank (Pre-APSA Political Economy Conference), McGill (Economics Seminar), Harvard (Cities Development Conference), NEUDC, Stanford (Centre for Population Health Sciences), Indian Statistical Institute (Delhi)

2020: NBER Summer Institute Public Economics, SUNY Binghamton, Urban Economics Association, Royal Bank of India / Cafral

2021: NBER Conference on Mortality, ETH Zurich, University of Ottawa, ACM, India Policy Forum, Center for Advanced Study on India at Penn, Yale, Trinity Dublin, UK FCDO, Ashoka

2022: Yale, UCSD, NBER Summer Institute Development, BREAD, University of Maryland, NBER Development

2023: University of Pittsburgh, University of Houston, USC, London School of Economics, Congressional Budget Office

2024: Brown, University of Wyoming, Wharton Business School, Yale YRISE Conference, Utah Business Economics Conference, Harvard

2025: Notre Dame, Opportunity Insights, Boston University, University of British Columbia

2026: George Washington University

Professional Activities

Referee: American Economic Review, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Journal of Political Economy, Review of Economic Studies, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, American Political Science Review, Economic Development and Cultural Change, Journal of Development Economics, Review of Economics and Statistics, among others

Co-organizer: Cities and Development Conference (since 2018), Dartmouth College External Applied Seminar (since 2016)

Conference reviewer: NEUDC (since 2014), Urban Economics Association Annual Conference (since 2022)

Member: BREAD, NBER Development, International Growth Centre

Creator / Maintainer: The SHRUG data platform (created and maintained since 2018), www.devdatalab.org/shrug

Predoctoral Experience

2007-08 Expert Group on Advanced Market Commitments, Analyst

2005-07 Government of Lesotho Ministry of Finance, Economic Advisor

2005-07 Baylor College of Medicine (Lesotho), Medical Software Developer

2004-05 Environment Canada, Policy Analyst

2001-02 International Rice Research Institute (Vietnam), Research Assistant

2000-01 Codefast.com Software Research Corporation, Software Engineer